



Calcium is found in seashells in the compound calcium carbonate.

The dazzling light of fireworks comes from burning magnesium.

Alkaline-earth metals

Five elements, including magnesium and calcium, are called alkaline-earth metals. Like alkali metals, they are soft and light. They don't react as strongly with water, but they join with other chemicals to make many compounds important in nature.

Noble gases

The six noble gases get their name because they hardly react with other chemicals, as though staying aloof. They include neon and argon, which are used to make lasers and colored lights.



Poor metals

The elements in this group are soft and weak. They are called poor metals but are very useful. Tin, lead, and aluminum are examples of poor metals.

Tin cans are actually made of steel with a thin coating of tin.

Halogens

Five elements make up a group called the halogens. These are all highly reactive chemicals. The gas chlorine is one of the best-known halogens. It is added to the water in swimming pools because it kills germs.

Chlorine smells strongly and can sting your eyes.

